



century by Portuguese colonists and given its independence in 1822, the Federative Republic of Brazil consists of 26 states plus a federal district that, since 1960, has been the setting for a specially created capital city,

Brasilia. Together, they accommodate the region's highest population. The name Brazil is believed to come from a Portuguese word for the distinctive red color of brazil wood—*brasa* means “glowing coals.”

MAKING COFFEE

Drunk in virtually every country on Earth, coffee is second only to oil as an international commodity, and Brazil is its leading producer worldwide. The raw crop undergoes several stages before it can be exported.

1 Picking

The cherries (fruit) on the coffee plant turn dark red when they are ready to be harvested. Handpicking is labor intensive, but it produces a high-quality crop.



2 Winnowing

Using a large sieve, the cherries are tossed into the air to remove dirt and leaves. This process (called winnowing) prepares them for drying and husking.



3 Tasting

Special tasters process a few of the beans into coffee, then sample it for acidity, body, aroma, and flavor before the rest of the batch is blended and roasted.



FRUIT FOR SALE

Although the Brazilian economy is no longer dominated by agriculture (manufacturing and service industries are also very important), one-third of its workforce is still employed on the land. Some of the country's most profitable exports are fruit crops, especially oranges and bananas.

A DREAM OF URBAN PLANNING



Curitiba in southern Brazil is one of the world's most efficient cities. Uniquely friendly to the environment (two-thirds of all garbage is recycled), it also provides extensive social welfare; here, street children are employed in an urban park.

“MARVELOUS CITY”

People who live in Rio de Janeiro call it the *Cidade Marvilhosa*, or marvelous city. Overlooking Rio, arms outstretched in welcome, stands the famous Statue of Christ the Redeemer, conceived and built in the Art Deco style by engineer Heitor da Silva Costa, and inaugurated in 1931.

